

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

1st Session of the 60th Legislature (2025)

HOUSE BILL 1822

By: Newton

AS INTRODUCED

An Act relating to transportation; defining term; requiring Oklahoma Department of Transportation establish and implement certain program; detailing program requirements; providing for codification; and providing an effective date.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 1239 of Title 69, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

A. As used in this section, the term "invasive woody species" means a tree or shrub species that is rapidly encroaching into adjoining lands and is likely to cause harm to the environment or economy. Invasive woody species include, but are not limited to, *Juniperus virginiana* (Eastern Redcedar), *Juniperus scopulorum* (Rocky Mountain juniper), *Juniperus monosperma* (oneseed juniper) and *Tamarix ramosissima* (salt cedar).

B. The Oklahoma Department of Transportation shall establish and implement a program for the systematic identification, removal,

1 and management of invasive woody species within rights-of-way under
2 its jurisdiction. The eradication program shall include the
3 following components:

4 1. Surveys to identify the presence and extent of invasive
5 woody species;

6 2. Development of a prioritized plan for eradication and
7 control;

8 3. Use of best management practices for removal, including
9 methods that minimize harm to native vegetation and prevent soil
10 erosion;

11 4. Monitoring and follow-up measures to prevent
12 reestablishment; and

13 5. Collaboration with local, state, and federal agencies, as
14 well as nongovernmental organizations, to leverage expertise and
15 resources.

16 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective November 1, 2025.

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